

Lab 47 Worksheet — Malware Symptom Response and Browser Problem Resolution

Name: ____ Date: ____

Exam objective: Recognise malware and browser symptoms, apply the containment sequence and resolve browser-specific problems (Core 2 objectives 3.2 and 3.3).

Record as you go

Step	What you did	What you observed
1	Record the containment rule that governs everything else: at the first credible sign of malware, disconnect the machine from the network before beginning any investigation.	
2	Build the malware symptom list: unexpected pop-ups, browser redirection, certificate warnings, sudden slowdown, disabled security tools, unexplained network traffic, new unfamiliar applications and files that will not open.	
3	Record the false alert symptom: a message claiming antivirus is missing or expired, delivered by a web page rather than by the installed product, is itself a social engineering attack.	
4	Diagnose certificate warnings by separating the causes: an expired certificate, a self-signed certificate, a wrong system clock, or an on-path interception — and record the check for each.	
5	Record that a certificate warning on a major site with a correct system clock is a serious signal and the connection must not be continued.	
6	Diagnose browser redirection: check the configured search provider and homepage, review installed extensions, check the proxy settings, and inspect the browser shortcut target	

Step	What you did	What you observed
	for appended arguments.	
7	Record why removing a malicious extension from the browser is not enough on its own — if a dropper persists in Windows it simply reinstalls the extension.	
8	Review the browser security settings that matter: pop-up blocker, clearing browsing data and cache, private browsing mode, ad blockers and sign-in data synchronisation.	
9	Record the browser installation rule: download only from the vendor's own site, verify the hash where published, and treat extensions from outside the official store as untrusted.	
10	Apply the seven-step removal procedure to a browser-symptom scenario and state the specific action at each step.	
11	Record the post-cleanup verification: confirm the symptom is gone, confirm security tools are running and updated, check for persistence in startup items and scheduled tasks, and rescan.	
12	Record the final step that is most often skipped: educate the user on how the infection arrived, because the same user on the same machine will otherwise repeat it.	

Verification

Success criterion: Your map covers at least eight malware symptoms and four browser symptoms with a response for each; network disconnection appears as the first containment action; the certificate warning causes are correctly separated; and post-cleanup verification includes checking persistence mechanisms.

- I completed every step in the lab.
- My result meets the success criterion above.
- I recorded my evidence (screenshots, output, completed tables).

Reflection

What surprised you in this lab?

Where would you apply this on the job?

What do you still need to revise before the exam?
